PATHFINDER CLUB

CHAIRMANSHIP

CHIBOMBA M. FELIX

The Seventh-day Adventist Youth Ministry programs are formed to serve the unique need of focusing youth energies on positive activities, leading to increased self-efficacy and the development of skills relevant to success in adulthood and the workplace such as decision-making and working well with others, in this complex world of diverse people.

Youth development is a process that prepares young people to navigate adolescence and realize their potential as an adult. An important aspect of youth development is leadership programming. While youth development programs meet basic physical, developmental, and social needs, leadership programs seek to position youth as leaders in their community, to take positions of leadership in companies, organizations and professional associations. Through youth leadership programs, young people gain the skills and knowledge to lead civic engagement, education reform, and community organizing activities, including church activities. Youth leadership is both an internal and an external process.

Honor in chairmanship, adopted by the General Conference of the Seventh-day Adventist Church is tailored to inculcate the aforementioned leadership skills in the youth.

CHIBOMBA FM
Chief Instructor

Chairmanship is an honor in which we learn how to organise, plan and preside over a meeting.

The person in charge of proceedings in a meeting is called the **Chairperson**. He or she acts as a referee to quick the members.

The purpose of chairpersonship is to maintain harmony and declare the will of the majority through a properly organised business transaction.

Qualities of a Chairperson:

- Must lead in the way of righteousness (Proverbs 8:20)
- Must be a spiritual man, one who is controlled by the Holy Spirit
- Must have authority to direct
- Must be a man of vision
- Must know his tool, rights, politics
- Must have love for God, the people and the organisation
- Must be a humble man
- Must be a man of courage, who will call a spade a spade
- Must be a man of integrity

What Every Chairperson Ought To Know:

- Do not be afraid to admit your mistakes
- Give attention to every view of a member
- Foster a spirit of unity and team work
- Get rightful men to sit in committees
- Identify yourself closely with the personal needs and desires of others
- Seek to avoid giving offense
- Be thoughtful of the feelings of others
- Give credit where it is due
- Practice the golden rule, 'do unto others what you want them to do unto you.'
- Do not make promises you cannot keep
- Counsel closely with your work mates. Do not tear them outside the meeting but build them
- Be friendly to the people you work with
- Arrange compatible men to work together. Do not let people at war work together or their personal prejudices may hamper progress
- Every member must know what is expected to be discussed where possible
- Let there be moderation. Moments are there when policy books must be referred to.

Key to decision making:

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- The Chairperson must know his destination, when to hold a meeting, what is to be discussed, duration, who to attend
- Allow one subject at a time
- Ensure full debate to the position presented
- Ensure free debate in the house
- Refocus discussion that has wandered off the point
- Always act as a referee
- Indicate progress, or lack of
- The will of the majority must be carried out
- The rights of the majority must be preserved
- Conclude one point and lead into the next
- The personal desires of each member must be merged into the larger group of the organisation
- Every member has rights that are equal to those of others
- Highlight important points
- The Chairperson must recognise the formation of subcommittees
- Clarify any misunderstanding
- The Chairperson must stick to the agenda
- Assist the secretary where necessary

The Chairperson's Attitude:

The Chair's attitude must be one of impartiality, of neutrality in respect to the various issues to be dealt with by the house. This is so even where the personal desire of the Chair are likely to be affected profoundly by the decision the house is called upon to reach.

The chairperson should pace the meeting, ensuring it runs to time. If the planning has been properly executed, this should not prove to be a problem.

At the end of the meeting, the chairperson should remind members what they have achieved and thank them for their contributions. Finally, the time and date of the next meeting should be arranged.

THE ROLE OF MEMBERS

- Undertake any necessary preparation prior to the meeting
- Always arrive on time
- Keep an open mind
- Listen to the opinions of others
- Participate
- Avoid dominating the proceedings

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- Avoid conflict situations
- Avoid side conversations which distract others
- Ask questions to clarify understanding
- Note down any action agreed on
- After the meeting, undertake any agreed action and brief others as appropriate

Rules of order

Public meetings, to be conducted in order, must operate on accepted rules of procedure. Therefore, every leader should possess some knowledge of the customs and rules of parliamentary order. Usually, only the most elementary rules are required

ORDER OF PROCEEDINGS (CHURCH MEETING)

Whoever is to preside over church business, AY, or any other meeting is usually called chairman or chairperson, though if any other term is adopted by the organization, such as president, the presiding officer is known by that title and is addressed, for instance, as "Mr. President" or "Madam President." In many instances, formality is dropped, however, speakers address the chair in order to avoid dvelopment of personality conflicts.

Every well-run organization/ meeting has an accepted order of business. The order used most often is as follows:

1. Opening song
2. Opening prayer
3. Devotion
4. Seasonal prayers (optional)
5. *Meeting called to order*. The chairperson or presiding officer stands and says, "The meeting will please come to order." If the meeting has been called specially, he should also briefly state the purpose of the meeting; why it has been called.
6. *Reading of the Agenda*. A list of items to be discussed is read by the secretary.
7. *Adoption of the Agenda or Agendum*. A motion to adopt the agenda for the meeting may be duly made and seconded from the floor, then voted upon.
8. *Roll call* by the secretary and response by the members. Each member responds by saying "Present" when his/her name is called, or by giving some other suitable response, or by writing down names on paper.
9. *Reading the minutes of the previous meeting.* These are read by the secretary, and are then open for corrections. Any member may make a correction by standing and addressing the chair. Or the presiding officer may simply tell the secretary what changes to make. The secretary then makes the corrections; if there are many of them, the minutes are re-read as corrected.
10. *Matters arising*. In case there are any concerns in the previous minutes, other than corrections that need to be addressed to the house; they may be raised or rather

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follow-up matters. E.g. "Previously we discussed that a team of eight should go and survey the campsite before camping. Have they done that?"

11. *Approval of the minutes.* A motion to accept the minutes may be duly made and seconded from the floor, then voted upon.
12. *Other items on the agenda are then discussed and resolved one at a time* holistically.
13. *Motion to adjourn.* This motion must be made and seconded like all other motions, but it is not debatable. The meeting is not adjourned until the motion is duly voted on and the presiding officer (or chairperson) announces that it has been carried. He then says, "The meeting is adjourned."
14. *Closing song and prayer*

CHURCH BOARD MEMBERS

The Church Board is the executive committee of the church. It comprises the church clerk, treasurer, all elders and departmental heads. The chairperson is the first elder and the secretary is the church clerk.

BUSINESS MEETING

This is the church council of local church members, baptized members only, which approves recommendations by the church board. The chairperson is the first elder and the secretary is the church Clerk.

COMMITTEES

A committee is a group of people formed to fulfil an objective. However, the type and the function depend on the objective of the committee.

1. **Standing committee** - This is an appointed or permanent committee with a longer life-span and it deals with regular or continuing issues e.g. the church board, the A.Y executive etc.
2. **Sub-committee** - Formed from the main committee to look into certain issues, e.g. camp meeting committee
3. **Adock Committee** - Has a short life span. Formed to fulfil an objective and ceases upon completing the task, e.g., wedding committee

Methods of Appointing the Nominating Committee:

There three ways, in which a nominating committee can be appointed, they are:

1. Nominating from the floor which is the special nominating committee which will then choose the nominating committee and brings the names to the church to vote
2. The church board can appoint the nominating committee in a similar way
3. A vote by ballot paper can be taken or used

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Advantages of committees:

i. Helps to settle disputes
ii. Provides information advice
iii. Improves communication

Disadvantages of Committees:

i. If wrong people are placed to sit in committees, it may yield bad results or poor performance
ii. If they become too big, it causes problems by trying to be independent.

Duties of Committee Members:

a. Punctuality at all meeting
b. To refer all issues to the chairperson even if your neighbour knows the answer
c. To pay attention to the reading of the minutes
d. Never to discuss committee work outside the meeting
e. Express your views during and after the meeting
f. Remember the chairperson's decision of point of procedure is final and should be given the loyal support
g. Be loyal to the decision made even if you voted against it
h. Bring any other issue in A.O.B.

How to Make Committees Succeed:

- Get right men and women to sit in committees
- Define the committee functions and goals properly
- Appoint a chair with leadership skills
- Record every transaction of the committee.

MODES OF VOTING

1. **By Acclamation (viva-voce) -** Voting by voice e.g. "those in favour say aye (yes) and those against say nay (no).
2. **By Raising the Right Hand (Division) -** This is where by those in favour of the motion raise up their hands.
3. **By Standing Up** - This is where by those in favour of the motion rise up by standing.
4. **By Secret Ballot (writing on a piece of paper) -** Voting secretly without anyone knowing what you voted for.
5. **By Calling the Roll** - This is a list of names which are called and people say yes or no in the end the chair counts the yes and the noes.

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6. **By Bell Calling -** This is where names are called out and people vote on each name called.

The Chairperson's Vote

The chairperson always has certain reserve privileges in voting. In most cases it is probably better if he (or she) does not vote, especially when the vote is public. He/she is the conductor of the debate and should, in most cases, remain as impartial to either side as possible. If the vote is a tie without the vote of the chairperson, he may, if he wishes, cast his vote in the affirmative and thus carry the motion. However, when voting by ballot, there is this important difference: the chairperson must vote with the other members, and then has no deciding vote.

MOTIONS

A motion is piece of statement brought to the house, seconded, discussed and voted to become legal or a motion is a precise statement of a proposed action, or simply a name used for the procedure of getting a matter before a group. When the motion is talked about and discussed, it is often called "the question."

There are eight types of motions, and they are:

- **Principal or Main Motion** - This is the first motion a raised by a member to propose for action. It takes precedence. No any other motion can be passed when the principle motion is still under consideration.
- **Subsidiary Motion** - This is the motion raised after the main motion has been discussed. It deals with pending matters, e.g. "I move that we table the motion." That is to say, putting off the matter to a future meeting.
- **Incidental Motion** - An incidental motion is one that comes up incidentally when other motions are being considered, and must be disposed of before the principal motion or a subsidiary motion can be acted upon.
- **Table the Motion** - This is to put off an item under discussion to a later time. This may be as result of insufficient information on the matter.
- **Motion on the Table** - Refers to items under consideration in the house.
- **Dilatory Motion** - Is a meaningless motion and must be ruled out of order by the chair.
- **Amendment Motion** - a change made to an already existing motion, constitution or by-law.
- **Amendment to Amendment Motion** - A change made to an amended motion.
- **Privileged motion** - this is a motion which does not need to be seconded is not debatable, amendable and it is good for adjournment, e.g. "I move that we adjourn."

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Without being seconded the chair states the motion, "there is a motion to adjourn, all in favour say I or all against say nay."

HOW TO MAKE A MOTION

1. ***Obtain the floor as follows:***
   Stand. (Except in very small or informal meetings, the president should also stand when speaking.) Address the chairperson or the presiding officer and say "Mr. Chairperson" or "Madam Chairlady." The chairperson then recognizes the speaker by saying "Mr. Campbell" or "Ms. Mutinta" The speaker may not present the motion until recognized by the chairperson.
2. ***State the motion carefully:***
   This is usually done by saying "I move that——————," or "I move the adoption of the following resolution."
3. ***The motion must then be seconded.***
   A motion cannot be discussed unless it is seconded; also, unless it receives a second, it is lost. Any eligible voter, other than the one who made the motion, may second it. He (or she) may remain seated, saying simply, "I second the motion." Or by raising the right hand up.
4. ***The chairperson must repeat the motion in full.***
   The usual statement is: "The motion has been made and seconded that . . . . . Is there any discussion?"
5. ***The Motion is then open for discussion***.
   This is done by members of the group, who obtain the floor.
6. **After the discussion, the vote is taken.**

FORMS OF CHURCH GOVERNMENT

1. **Apostolic/Democratic Form**-People are free to take part in the governing of the church and electing delegates to conferences. All members are equal in ranks, e.g. Apostolic Church, Presbyterian Church and the S.D.A Church.
2. **Papal Form**-This is a form of church governance were supreme authority is vested in the pop. Other subsequent delegating is through the Cardinals, Archbishops, Bishops and Priests.
3. **Episcopal Form**-This is the governing of the church through Bishops, Priests and Deacons.
4. **Independent type of Government Form**-This is where the local church makes its own decision or policies without interference from higher authorities.

GUIDING PRINCIPLES ON WHO TO SPEAK

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- The chair should always show preference to the proposer of the motion to allow him explain his views
- A member who has not spoken has prior claim over one who has already discussed the question
- The chair should show preference to the opposed to be the last speaker
- The chair should show preference to a member who seldom speaks to one who frequently claims the floor of the house
- A member who raises his hand first when all have spoken stands priority
- When a member stands to speak, he must speak to the chair. No member should mention the name of the pre-current speaker or turn to face him as this may cause confusion by direct confrontation.

TWO POINTS TO BE NOTED BY THE SPEAKER

- If the chairperson intervenes to speak to the speaker himself, the speaker may remain standing but remain silent when the chairperson is addressing him.
- If the chairperson intervenes to speak to some other person, the speaker must at once resume his seat and wait until called upon to continue. If any other person seeks to intervene, the speaker may ignore him, but if the chairperson signifies that the intervener be heard, the speaker must at once resume his seat.

RULES OF DEBATE

- The chairperson is at all times in charge of proceedings and if the chair rises to speak accept after adjourning the meeting, all other persons shall stop speaking and shall resume their seats or remain seated.
- The speaker must regard himself us subject to the directions of the chairperson.

FUNCTIONS OF THE MEETING

- In order to discuss common problems
- To communicate information
- For receiving and reviewing of progress and determining facts on work plan
- For planning & decision making
- Generating ideas especially if you involve other people
- For connecting activities

Other consideration for effective meeting includes:

- Chairperson's authority: group leader's authority should not be questionable. No member should dispute his authority. Needs to be firm.

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Regarding relationship of members in the meeting:

- Members in the meeting: it is the duty of the chairperson to set the tone.
- Meeting should move forward all the time. All aspects which have been discussed should not be revised.

Common problems associated with meetings:

- People do destructive things during the meeting e.g. passing small pieces of paper in the meetings.
- People come late and leave early
- Some people dominate the meeting and can be an act of frustration
- Non participation of members
- Too long reports can be boring
- People discussing many issues without focus and not arriving at a decision.

OTHER CHAIRPERSONSHIP TERMS

- **Adjourn** - To close the meeting or session.
- **Amend** - To change a motion by means of another motion.
- **Amendment** - A change made in a previous motion. Such an amendment is debatable and may be reconsidered.
- **Appeal from decision of the chair** - An incidental motion. Any member disagreeing with the chairperson's decision may thus put the matter to a vote of the assembly. This is an order, even though another member has the floor. The member rises saying, "I appeal from the decision of the chair." If the appeal is seconded, the chairperson must say, "Shall the decision of the chair be sustained?" It cannot be amended but may be reconsidered. A tie vote sustains the chair.
- **Assembly** – A group of eligible voters gathered to transact the business of the organization.
- **Chairperson** - The person who presides at the meeting and who may be the president. The chairperson acts in the capacity of umpire. Remarks by members are always addressed to the chairperson.
- **Committee of the whole** - A method used to allow an assembly to consider a question with greater freedom than its rules allow. The committee of the whole, therefore, comprises the entire assembly.
- **Convene** - To meet, or call to order.
- **Debatable** - The discussion of a motion or question according to the rules of order.
- **Discussion** - Debating or talking about a motion or question. Discussion must always follow the accepted rules of order.

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- **Division of the house** - If any member of the assembly is dissatisfied with the result of the vote as announced by the chairperson or Secretary, he may call for a "division of the house," or "division of the assembly," or just "division." The chairperson then says, "A division is called for; those in favour of the motion will rise." The chairperson then appoints "tellers" to count those standing. Announcing the number, the chairperson then says, "Those opposed will rise." They are also counted by the teller, and the chairperson announces the result.
- **Fix time to which to adjourn** - This is a privileged motion which takes precedence over all others.
- **Lay on the table** - A subsidiary motion, the purpose of which is to postpone consideration to a more convenient time. This is often considered a polite way of defeating a motion with the assumption that it is to lie on the table permanently. If carried, a motion to "lay on the table" usually takes with it everything concerned with the question. It is not debatable, and cannot be amended.
- **Majority** - Over half the votes cast.
- **Meeting** - The time an assembly remains together without adjournment. A call to order after an adjournment constitutes another meeting.
- **Minutes** - The written records of the proceedings of the meetings, as kept by the secretary.
- **Motion** - The accepted name applied to the procedure of getting a matter before a group or assembly.
- **New business** - Matters which have not been formally discussed before, but are brought up for the first time.
- **Nomination** - Suggesting the name of a person for an office, to be used at the time of election.
- **Objection to consideration of a question** - An incidental motion. The objective of this motion is to avoid consideration of a question which is irrelevant or otherwise improper. Such an objection may be made to any principal motion, but only when it is first introduced and before it is debated. It can be made when another member has the floor, and does not require a second. It cannot be debated or amended. The chairperson may decide the point, or may put the question, "Will the assembly consider it?" If decided in the negative by a two-thirds vote, the matter is dismissed.
- **Obtain the floor** - Securing the right to speak, either to make or discuss a motion.
- **Plurality** - The person receiving the greatest number of votes.
- **Point of order** - An incidental motion made to correct disorder in the proceedings or in the deportment of members. Any member may obtain the floor and say, "I rise to a point of order." The member then states the point, and the chairperson decides whether it is well taken. It does not require a second, and cannot be debated except

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that the chairperson may ask for the opinions of others before giving his decision. Neither can it be amended, but it may be reconsidered.

- **Question** - The motion before the assembly is called "the question." When members wish to close the discussion and put the matter to a vote they may call "Question."
- **Quorum** - A sufficient number of members present at a meeting to transact business. This number is usually a majority unless otherwise specified in the constitution.
- **Reading of papers** - An incidental motion. Every member has the right to hear papers read once before he is compelled to vote on them. When thus requested, the chairperson may ask that the papers be read, or may put the. Such a motion cannot be debated or amended.
- **Recess, Take a** - A privileged motion used to secure a resting period or intermission without adjourning the meeting. If the time to resume the meeting is named in the motion to take a recess, it cannot be amended or debated. However, if the time is not named, it may be debated or amended.
- **Reconsider** - "To reconsider" is a means whereby a decision once made and which later seems wrong, may be corrected or changed. It must be made by some persons who voted on the affirmative side of the question. It cannot be amended or reconsidered. If carried, the original question is again put before the assembly.
- **Refer to a committee** - This is often called to "commit" or "refer" or "recommit" and is a subsidiary motion. The usual form of the motion is to "refer the matter to a committee," and it is well to name in the motion the committee if a standing one, or the method to be used in selecting the committee. Such a motion is debatable, and may be amended by altering the committee, or by giving it more specific instruction.
- **Reports** - The records or findings of officers or committees (preferably in written form) which are submitted for consideration and approval at a meeting of the main body.
- **Rescind** - A motion to rescind is designed to nullify a former action of a group or assembly when it is too late to reconsider the action.
- **Resolution** - A formal type of principal motion.
- **Second** - An indication that at least a second person approves of the motion.
- **Simple motion** - Rather simple type of principal motion.
- **Special committee** - A committee chosen for some particular purpose. When its objective is attained, the special committee is usually discontinued automatically. However, a special committee, when it has not completed its work, may ask permission of the main body to "sit again."
- **Standing committee** - A committee appointed for a long period of time, often a year. Such committees are frequently named in the constitution.

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- **Suspend the rules** - An incidental motion used in urgent cases to save time. Usually resorted to only by unanimous consent. Cannot be amended or reconsidered.
- **Unanimous ballot** - A ballot cast by the secretary or clerk for a candidate when he is the only person nominated for a particular office, and no one objects to him for that office. The usual form is for the chairperson to instruct the secretary to "cast an unanimous ballot" for the candidate for the certain office. However, if anyone objects, the balloting must be done in the usual way.
- **Unfinished business** - Motions that have not yet been decided, and have been left over from preceding meetings.
- **Withdraw a motion** - An incidental motion permitting a previous motion to be withdrawn. It is not debatable, cannot be amended, but may be reconsidered. However, a motion may be withdrawn by the person who made it with the consent of the person who seconded it and the chairperson of the meeting, if done before decision or amendment.
- **Yeas and nays** - A method of voting, sometimes called voting by roll call.